April: 18.3% of new mothers on one ward died.

> By July: 1.2%.

Two clinics. One hospital.

DOCTORS' CLINIC

~10% died

MIDWIVES' CLINIC

Under 4%

Ignaz Semmelweis wanted to know why.

His friend Jakob Kolletschka died after a cut during an autopsy.

Doctors went from autopsies to deliveries, carrying something on their hands.

New rule: wash in chlorinated lime before every exam.

🧪 Chlorinated lime

🙌 Every exam

👶 Every delivery

Maternal deaths, First Clinic, 1847

Monthly rates from Semmelweis's records; May (change month) omitted

He was largely ignored. Died in 1865, aged 47.

> 'The Semmelweis reflex': rejecting evidence that clashes with habit.

DO THIS TODAY

The 20-second habit:

1. Before you eat
2. When you get home
3. 20 seconds, soap, every time

@bino_da_producer

Save this ↓